



CORE PRINCIPLES

THE WORLD EXISTS



The world is larger than the characters and continues to move whether they act or not.

SITUATIONS, NOT PLOTS



Prepare places, people, and problems. Not outcomes.

PLAYER AGENCY



The players decide what matters. You adjudicate and react.

CONSEQUENCES CREATE HISTORY



Every action has results. History emerges from accumulated consequences.

LUCK & CHAOS



Fortune and chaos shape the world. Expect the unexpected.

PLAY TO FIND OUT



You don't know how it will end. Discover the story together.

THE GM CYCLE (DCC)



1 ESTABLISH SITUATION
What's happening now? Who, what, where, and why? What are the threats and opportunities?



2 PRESENT ENCOUNTER
Offer a meaningful encounter: Combat, Social, Exploration, Environmental, or Discovery.



3 PLAYER DECISION
What do the players do? Fight, negotiate, investigate, avoid, exploit, retreat, or something else?



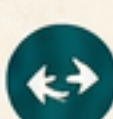
4 RESOLVE ACTIONS
Use DCC rules to determine outcomes. Roll dice, apply modifiers, and judge success or failure.



5 APPLY CONSEQUENCES
What happens as a result? Resources change. Goals advance or are blocked. People react.



6 UPDATE WORLD STATE
Factions act, NPCs react, locations change. The world moves forward.



7 GENERATE NEW SITUATIONS
New encounters, new opportunities, new problems. The cycle continues.



THE CAMPAIGN IS THE HISTORY OF WHAT HAPPENED.
Situations + Choices + Consequences
= Emergent History

DCC COMBAT RESOLUTION

- 1 MAKE AN ATTACK**
Roll d20 + Attack Bonus
- 2 DETERMINE DEFENSE**
Roll d20 + Defense Bonus
- 3 COMPARE RESULTS**
Attack roll vs. Defense roll

ATTACKER'S RESULT	OUTCOME
Higher by 10+	Critical Hit
Higher	Hit
Same	Trade
Lower	Miss
Lower by 10+	Critical Miss

- 4 APPLY DAMAGE**
Roll weapon damage. Apply any effects.

- 5 CHECK FOR SPECIAL EFFECTS**
Spells, abilities, monsters, and magic items may trigger additional effects.



LUCK (USE FREELY!)

Players may spend Luck to:

- Reroll their own d20
- Take 20 on a roll
- Act before others in a round
- Avoid or reduce the impact of a result
- Recover from a bad situation

You may grant Luck for great roleplay, courage, and creative solutions.



WILD MAGIC

When a spellcaster rolls a natural 1 on a spell roll:

Roll on the Wild Magic Table (p. 72).

Expect the unexpected! Chaos is part of the world.

DCC CHECKS (WHEN NOT IN COMBAT)

Roll d20 + Ability Modifier

RESULT	OUTCOME
20+	Critical Success
15-19	Success
10-14	Partial Success
5-9	Failure
0-4	Critical Failure

ATTRIBUTE MODIFIERS

Score	Modifier
3	-3
4-5	-2
6-8	-1
9-12	0
13-15	+1
16-17	+2
18	+3



BUILD ENCOUNTERS

- Define the objective(s).
- Choose opponents and allies.
- Consider terrain and environment.
- Add complications or twists.
- Know what happens if they ignore it.



USE NPCs EFFECTIVELY

- Give them a goal.
- Give them a personality.
- Give them resources.
- Decide how they react and adapt.
- Let them remember.



RUN FACTIONS ACTIVELY

For each faction, know:

- Goal
- Resources
- Allies & enemies
- Current plan
- Next action

Advance factions after significant events.



RANDOMIZATION TOOLS

Use tables to generate:

- Encounters
- Locations
- NPCs
- Treasures
- Events

Interpret results. Don't be ruled by them.



ADJUDICATION GUIDELINES

- Be consistent, not rigid.
- Rulings > Rules in the moment.
- Keep the game moving.
- Fair ≠ Equal.
- Explain your call. Move on.

WHAT TO PREPARE

EVERY SESSION

- 2-5 Encounters
- 2 Interesting Locations
- 3 Memorable NPCs
- 1 Faction Action
- 1 Random Event
- 1 Strange Element

EVERY CAMPAIGN

- Regional Map
- Active Factions
- Encounter Tables
- Treasure Tables
- Major Threats
- Timeline of Events

Flexible. Focused. Playable.

The world runs whether or not they show up.

DCC RANDOM TABLES (USE OFTEN!)

Roll d66 or d30 as indicated in the rulebook.

- Dungeon Dressing
- Encounter
- Monster & NPC
- Treasure
- Magic Item
- Weird & Wonderful
- Omens & Events
- Backstory & Rumors



SOURCES OF INSPIRATION (STEAL THE SITUATION)

- YOJIMBO**
Rival factions competing for control.
- THE HOBBIT**
A dangerous expedition into the unknown.
- THE RUNNING MAN**
Deadly competition where survival is entertainment.
- CONAN THE BARBARIAN**
Brutal worlds, hard choices, and personal vendettas.
- X-MEN**
Feared outsiders, mysterious abilities, and secrets.

Steal the situation, not the story. Let the players decide how it ends.

TRACK CONSEQUENCES

- Who lives or dies.
- Who gains or loses resources.
- Who becomes an ally or enemy.
- What locations change.
- What opportunities open or close.
- What the world remembers.

Write it down. Let it matter.



DCC CORE REMINDERS

Funnel characters may die. That's DCC. Embrace the danger.



LUCK FAVORS THE BOLD.



CHAOS SHAPES DESTINY.



THE WORLD ISN'T FAIR.



YOU ARE THE REFEREE, NOT THE AUTHOR.